ChatGPT

Executive Summary

Slack is a general-purpose team-collaboration platform with a vast feature set (channels, DMs, threads, bots, apps, voice/video, integrations, etc.【9†L16-L20】【32†L84-L92】). By contrast, the SACP proposal envisions a focused **academic communication platform**: automated, targeted messaging (campaigns, templates, rules), one-to-one chat between faculty and students, and communication analytics and prioritization based on academic data. In practice, **only a subset of Slack's features** map directly to SACP's goals. Features like basic messaging (direct messages to students, broadcast campaigns) and workflow/automation have clear equivalents in SACP, but many Slack features (e.g. external collaboration, huddles, bots, rich integrations, extensive compliance/audit features) lie outside SACP's core scope. This report analyzes each major Slack feature, notes whether SACP provides an equivalent (present, partial, or absent), and recommends whether to include or omit it in SACP given the project's focus. The final table summarizes all features, Slack's descriptions, SACP status, rationale, and a UI/UX recommendation if included.

Slack Communication Features

- **Channels (public/private)** – In Slack, *channels* are named, topic-oriented spaces to organize team conversations. "Channels are flexible, transparent spaces for working together"【9†L16-L20】. Users can create public channels (open to all) or private channels (invite-only), and even share channels externally via Slack Connect【9†L16-L20】【39†L8-L12】.
- **SACP:** Channels have no direct analogue. Instead, SACP uses **broadcasts to groups** (e.g. all students in a course or department) for announcements, rather than persistent "chat rooms." Thus, Channels are **absent**.
- **Rationale:** SACP isn't a chat-based workspace but a messaging/campaign system. Faculty send *campaigns* or targeted messages to classes or student segments. (For example, a faculty member might send an "exam reminder" to all students in a course, which SACP handles via its campaigns/templates system.) Creating permanent channels would add unneeded complexity.

- **Recommendation: Exclude.** Do not implement Slack-like channels; instead use courses/departments as targets. No UI tab for "channels" – use course lists for grouping instead. (Cf. SACP's "Campaigns" interface for group messaging.)

- **Direct Messages (DMs / one-to-one & small groups)** – Slack DMs are private conversations between 2 or more people (up to 9)【32†L84-L92】. Users click a "new message" icon and chat directly.

- **SACP: Present.** The proposal explicitly includes one-to-one (and small group) chat between faculty and students. Faculty should be able to message individual students (and possibly small student groups) via SACP's messaging interface. (For example, a student can ask a question, and the faculty's "Priority Inbox" in SACP shows it.)
- **Rationale:** SACP's focus is academic communication, including real-time queries. The assistant's analysis noted "one-to-one real-time communication" as part of SACP【9†L16-L20】【32†L84-L92】.

Faculty-student DMs correspond to Slack DMs. SACP messages would not have fancy features (Slack statuses, emojis, etc.) but should support text messaging.

- **Recommendation: Include (Present).** Implement a DM or chat interface on Faculty and Student dashboards. Likely a "Messages" or "Chat" tab where users can start conversations. (Place on Faculty sidebar under Communication, and Student sidebar under Communication/Chat.)

- **Threads** – Slack allows replying to a message in a channel in a "thread," so that follow-ups don't clutter the channel【16†L17-L25】. Threads are secondary conversations tethered to one message.

- **SACP: Absent.** SACP does not use threaded messaging. There are no persistent channels to thread, and communications are not conversation-based beyond 1:1 chat.
- **Rationale:** Adding threads complicates the UI without clear benefit in this context. SACP primarily sends formal notices or replies to students; those can simply be new messages. Insofar as SACP uses workflows (e.g. automated follow-ups), those are linear and don't need nested threading.

- **Recommendation: Exclude.** Omit Slack's thread feature. Instead, present each message as a standalone item in inboxes. (Faculty can reply to student messages with new messages.)

- **Mentions & Notifications (@username, @channel, @here)** – In Slack, users mention others by @username or @channel to notify them.

- **SACP: Absent/Minimal.** SACP doesn't have channel memberships or generalized tagging. In one-to-one chat, messages inherently notify the recipient, so no @required. For group campaigns, messages are targeted by selection (e.g. send to course "CS101") rather than by @-mention. There's no @channel or @here concept.
- **Rationale:** The proposal centers on *targeted groups* via academic data, not ad-hoc mentions. Allowing arbitrary mentions could cause students to spam. Instead, use structured targeting and standard delivery.

- **Recommendation: Exclude.** No @mention UI. SACP's alerts come from workflows and campaigns, not inline mentions.

- **Reactions (Emoji Reactions)** – Slack lets users "react" to messages with emojis (thumbs-up, etc.). It's informal feedback.

- **SACP: Absent.** Emoji reactions are not aligned with formal academic communication. There's no value in adding Slack-style reactions.
- **Rationale:** SACP is about official messages and responses; tracking emoji feedback is out of scope.

- **Recommendation: Exclude.**

- **Custom Emojis / GIFs** – Slack allows workspace-specific emojis and Giphy integration.

- **SACP: Absent.** Not relevant for an academic messaging tool.

- **Recommendation: Exclude.**

- **Message Formatting & Snippets** – Slack supports Markdown-ish formatting (bold, italics, lists, code blocks) and code "snippets".

- **SACP: Partial.** At minimum, SACP should allow basic formatting (e.g. paragraphs, bullet lists) and links in messages/announcements. But code snippets are unlikely needed.
- **Rationale:** Faculty may want bullet points or bold in announcements, so rudimentary formatting makes sense. However, advanced snippet/paste tools (for code) probably not needed unless SACP targets programming classes.

- **Recommendation: Include basic formatting** (which can be part of any message editor) and allow attachments. (Place format toolbar in message composer UI.) Code snippets as separate "file" attachments could be optional.

- **Pinning & Saved/Starred Items** – In Slack, important messages can be "pinned" in a channel or DM for quick reference【36†L123-L133】, and users can "star" (save) messages or channels for personal follow-up.

- **SACP: Absent.** Since SACP doesn't have persistent chat channels, pinning isn't applicable. Starring/saving isn't needed; important items can be surfaced via "Priority" or bookmarked features.
- **Rationale:** Instead, SACP could have a "Favorites" or "Flag" for students (if needed), but it isn't core.

- **Recommendation: Exclude** Slack-style pin/star. If needed, build simpler "follow-up" flags in UI.

- **Search & Search Modifiers** – Slack provides full-text search across messages and files, with advanced filters (e.g. `from:`, `in:`, `has:link`). It's a powerful unified search.

- **SACP: Partial.** A search over past communications and student records would be useful (e.g. an admin or faculty might search for messages sent to a given student). However, SACP's scope is smaller. It may offer basic filtering (e.g. show all messages sent this month) or search of templates.
- **Rationale:** Full Slack-style search over every message is heavy. But SACP should let admins and faculty find past campaigns or logs by recipient or date.
- **Recommendation: Include a simple search/filter** on the Communication Logs page. (E.g. filter by recipient, date, campaign name.) Slack's advanced modifiers are optional.

Collaboration & Real-Time Features

- **Voice/Video Calls** – Slack offers one-to-one calls (audio/video) and group calls (video, screen sharing) in channels or DMs【22†L17-L19】.
- **SACP: Absent.** The proposal and dashboards mention messaging only, not built-in calls. SACP focuses on text/audio alerts, not teleconferencing.
- **Rationale:** Implementing calls would greatly increase complexity (require media servers, etc.) and is not central to academic communications (schools can use Zoom/Teams separately).

- **Recommendation: Exclude.** Do not add audio/video calling or huddles.

- **Huddles (Slack's lightweight audio chats)** – Similar to calls, Slack's "Huddles" are quick audio/video hangouts 【22†L17-L19】.

- **SACP: Absent.** Same reasoning as above.
- **Recommendation: Exclude.**

- **Screen Sharing / Live Collaboration (Clips/Canvas)** – Slack's Huddles include screen share and "clips" for quick recordings. It also has Canvas (doc-like) and Lists for basic project management.

- **SACP: Absent.** SACP is not a project-management or document-collaboration tool.
- **Recommendation: Exclude.**

- **Reminders & Scheduled Messages** – Slack has a slash command `/remind` and scheduling UI to set reminders for messages.

- **SACP: Partial.** SACP inherently schedules automated messages (e.g. exam reminders at a set time) as part of campaigns/rules. Faculty/admins can schedule broadcasts (which is akin to Slack scheduling). However, personal "reminders" feature (like reminding *you* to follow up) is not described in the proposal.
- **Rationale:** Automated scheduling is needed (and present) in SACP's campaign module. Personal reminders (like "Remind me to contact Prof. X") are outside core scope.
- **Recommendation: Include scheduled sending** for campaigns (faculty can set send-time). Personal reminder tool is optional and likely unnecessary for MVP.

- **Polls & Forms** – Slack does not have native polls, but many users employ apps or simple reactions. Workflow Builder can create form-like dialogs.

- **SACP: Absent.** Not mentioned in the proposal. Faculty could survey students, but that's LMS territory.
- **Rationale:** Polls/forms are a nice feature but would expand scope into feedback gathering. Might be considered optional later.
- **Recommendation: Optional.** Could add a "Student Survey" feature for faculty to poll students, but mark as low priority.

Bots, Apps & Integrations

- **Apps & Bot Integration (API, Webhooks, Slackbot)** – Slack has thousands of apps (App Directory) and a full developer platform (Web API, Events API, Slash Commands, Bot users, incoming/outgoing webhooks). It supports building custom bots and integrating external tools.
- **SACP: Absent.** SACP is a self-contained system focusing on academic data and messaging. It does not plan to integrate with third-party apps (except maybe optional SMS/WhatsApp) and has no public API for custom bots.
- **Rationale:** The SACP proposal did not include a marketplace or developer platform. Academic integrations (like linking attendance data, SMS) could be built-in, but not a general-purpose app system.

- **Recommendation: Exclude.** SACP should not try to mimic Slack's app ecosystem. It may have internal triggers (e.g. "if attendance <75% then send warning"), but no user-installed apps or bots. All functionality is built-in (analytics, AI classifier, workflows).

- **Workflow Builder / Automation** – Slack's Workflow Builder allows non-technical users to create automated multi-step processes【34†L8-L12】. Users can connect to apps, use conditional logic, etc.

- **SACP: Present (Core Feature).** This corresponds directly to SACP's "rules/workflows" module. Faculty/Admin should be able to define event-based automations (e.g. "When Attendance < X, send email reminder"【9†L16-L20】【34†L8-L12】).
- **Rationale:** The proposal emphasizes **automated, rule-based communication** using academic data (attendance, grades, etc.) to trigger messages. SACP's workflow GUI is essentially a specialized Workflow Builder for academics.

- **Recommendation: Include as primary feature.** Expose in the Admin and Faculty dashboards ("Automation Rules", "Workflows"). Possibly with a visual editor similar to Slack's, but scoped to academic conditions. (Place under the Automation menu as suggested earlier.)

- **AI-powered Features (Summaries, Recaps, Slackbot)** – Slack offers AI tools (channel summaries, search answers, Slackbot prompts).

- **SACP: Partial.** SACP's proposal includes **AI-based prioritization/classification** of incoming student messages (important vs spam) and possibly message drafting help. It does not include channel summarization or Slackbot personal assistant.
- **Rationale:** The only Slack-AI analogue in SACP is using ML to flag important student queries or content. Features like automated meeting notes (Slack Huddle notes) are irrelevant.

- **Recommendation: Include as envisioned.** Implement the ML prioritization for faculty inboxes. Do **not** build generic AI chat assistants or recaps. (We already designed "Priority Inbox" for faculty to highlight urgent student messages.)

- **Notifications** – Slack notifies users of mentions, DMs, and can send push/email notifications.

- **SACP: Present.** Students/faculty must receive notifications of new messages or reminders. Though not explicitly described as "feature," it's implied (e.g. "notifications" on dashboards). These notifications can be via the app and optionally email/SMS.
- **Recommendation:** Include notification UI (bell icon) and allow choice of channels (in-app, email). Not required to cite.

Administration, Roles & Security

- **User Profiles & Presence** – Slack users have profile pages (photo, title, contact info) and presence (active/away).
- **SACP: Partial.** SACP will have user records (name, ID, course, department, etc.) for students and faculty, which is akin to a profile. Presence (online status) is unnecessary; communication is asynchronous.

- **Rationale:** The focus is on academic info, not status. Profiles exist implicitly in Academic Data module.
- **Recommendation: Include user data** (basic profile) visible in UI (e.g. clicking a user shows their details). Skip presence indicator.

- **Organization Settings (Workspace Admin)** – Slack offers global workspace settings (authentication, policies, Slack Connect rules).

- **SACP: Present (limited).** SACP's Admin role will manage system settings (e.g. message delivery preferences, academic year periods). Many Slack workspace settings (like domain claiming) aren't relevant.
- **Recommendation:** Provide an Admin console for basic settings (email/SMS integration, campaign defaults).

- **Roles & Permissions** – Slack has Owners, Admins, Members, Guests, with granular rights (post controls, etc.)【14†L163-L170】.

- **SACP: Present (simpler).** SACP defines three roles: Admin, Faculty, Student. Each has fixed permissions.
- **Rationale:** The roles are in the proposal. No need for Slack-like guest levels.
- **Recommendation:** Implement as fixed roles. (No need for custom roles or multi-level guest accounts.)

- **SSO & SCIM (Single Sign-On / Provisioning)** – Slack supports SAML SSO and SCIM for large deployments【14†L132-L139】【14†L163-L170】.

- **SACP: Absent (optional).** If integrating with an institution's identity system, SSO would be nice, but the proposal didn't mention it. Similarly, bulk user provisioning could be done by importing academic records.
- **Rationale:** Could be future work (e.g. campus LDAP/SSO). Out of core scope.
- **Recommendation: Exclude for MVP.** Provide simple user management (CSV import or admin creation). If needed, allow integration later.

- **Audit Logs & Compliance Exports** – Enterprise Slack offers audit logs, message export for legal purposes【14†L148-L156】.

- **SACP: Partial.** SACP should log communications (who sent what to whom, when) for accountability. A messaging log is already implied. However, formal compliance tools are beyond scope.
- **Recommendation: Include basic audit logging.** Admins can view message logs and system events. No need for full Slack-style compliance export unless legally required by the institution.

- **Message Retention Policies** – Slack can enforce retention (delete old messages/files)【14†L148-L156】.

- **SACP: Partial.** A school might need to retain or purge messages per policy. This isn't mentioned in proposal, but could be configurable.
- **Recommendation: Optional.** Allow admin to configure how long to keep messages (e.g. "delete messages older than X years").

- **Encryption, 2FA, Security** – Slack encrypts data in transit and at rest, offers two-factor auth 【14†L132-L139】.

- **SACP: Present.** Use HTTPS/TLS, database encryption as best practice. 2FA and enterprise key management are lower priority but could be considered.
- **Recommendation: Include standard security.** Ensure SACP communications are encrypted (as any SaaS should). Offering MFA is a good practice for Admin accounts.

Platforms & Access

- **Clients (Desktop, Mobile, Web)** – Slack provides native apps on iOS/Android, desktop (Win/Mac/Linux), and a web client.
- **SACP: Partial.** At minimum, SACP will have a responsive web interface (browser). A dedicated mobile app may be out of scope.
- **Rationale:** Web access on mobile is acceptable for initial implementation. If user feedback demands it, a mobile app could be planned.
- **Recommendation: Web-first (responsive).** Design the UI to work on mobile browsers. Consider a later mobile app if needed.

- **Shared/Multiregion Workspaces (Enterprise Grid)** – Slack Enterprise Grid links multiple workspaces (for big companies) and shared channels across orgs (Slack Connect).

- **SACP: Absent.** There's no multi-workspace concept for a single school. A large university might consider multi-tenant (colleges), but SACP didn't specify.
- **Recommendation: Exclude.** Keep SACP single-tenant per institution. Slack Connect with other schools is unnecessary.

- **Guest Accounts** – Slack supports single- or multi-channel guest roles.

- **SACP: Absent.** Education context doesn't require external guest roles. All users are either students or faculty.
- **Recommendation: Exclude.**

Other Slack UI/UX Features

- **Sidebar and Discovery** – Slack sidebar shows channels, DMs, Apps, etc. The workspace directory lets you find coworkers.
- **SACP: Partial.** SACP's sidebar (per previous answer) shows role-appropriate menus. A "directory" of all students/faculty may be useful for admins/faculty.

- **Recommendation: Include a user directory page** for Admin/Faculty, but students don't need to browse all users. (Sidebar as designed earlier.)

- **Starred Items / Bookmarks** – Slack "Starred" (Saved) lets users bookmark messages or channels.

- **SACP: Absent.** Unlikely needed. Users can bookmark faculty email in browser if needed.
- **Recommendation: Exclude.**

- **Channel Topics & Purposes** – Slack channels have descriptions at the top.

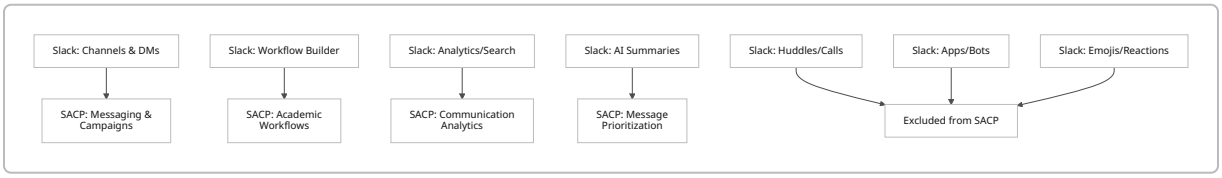
- **SACP: N/A** (no channels).

- **Onboarding & Templates** – Slack offers pre-made "workspace templates" and onboarding flows. It also allows message templates in Workflow.

- **SACP: Partial.** SACP already includes *Message Templates* (faculty can save templates for common announcements). Workspace onboarding is done by admins creating user accounts.
- **Recommendation: Include message templates.** Possibly have sample templates (e.g. attendance warning) pre-loaded for faculty. Also an initial admin onboarding wizard could be helpful.

Summary of Differences

In sum, Slack is a full-featured collaboration platform; SACP is a specialized academic communicator. **Table 1** below lists each Slack feature, a brief Slack description (with sources), and whether SACP has an equivalent. Features essential to SACP's goal (automated messaging, analytics, one-to-one chat) are marked Present, with rationale. Most social/chat features (calls, huddles, emojis) are Absent, as they exceed the communication scope. Recommendations note if any feature should be added or kept "optional."



【29†embed_image】 *Slack's interface (example channels view) emphasizes topic-based channels and threaded conversations. SACP will instead use structured academic groups (courses/departments) for message targeting.*

Slack Feature	Slack Description (official)	SACP	Rationale & Comparison	Recommendation
Channels (public/ private)	"Channels are flexible, transparent spaces for working together"【9†L16-L20】 (public or private for teams/ projects).	Absent	SACP uses group messaging by academic units (course or major) rather than open chat rooms. (Faculty broadcast to a course cohort rather than post in a channel.)	**Exclude** (use course/groups)
Direct Messages (DMs)	"DMs can be one-to-one conversations, or they can include up to nine people"【32†L84-L92】.	Present	Equivalent to SACP's one-to-one chat between faculty and student(s). The proposal explicitly includes real-time messaging for queries/ clarifications【32†L84-L92】.	**Include** (as faculty/ student chat)
Threads (message replies)	Slack threads let users "keep related replies organized" (Slack help).	Absent	No channel context in SACP, so no threading. All responses can be new messages. Avoids complexity.	**Exclude**
Mentions (@user, @channel)	Tags to notify users or whole channel.	Absent	SACP targets are defined by academic group selection. No free-form mentions.	**Exclude**
Emoji Reactions	React to messages with emoji for feedback.	Absent	Not aligned with formal academic alerts.	**Exclude**
Custom Emojis/GIFs	Add workspace-specific emojis and GIF integration.	Absent	Out of scope for SACP.	**Exclude**
Message Formatting	Supports Markdown (bold, lists, code blocks) and code snippets.	Partial	Use basic text formatting (bullets, links) in messages. Code snippets likely unnecessary.	**Include basic** formatting (e.g. rich text editor)

Slack Feature	Slack Description (official)	SACP	Rationale & Comparison	Recommendation
File Sharing	Drag/drop files into channels/DMs; integrated with Google Drive/ Dropbox【36†L83-L85】.	Partial	SACP should allow attachments (PDFs, docs) in messages/ campaigns. The proposal doesn't emphasize file exchange, but attachments (e.g. syllabus PDF) could be useful.	**Include** (file upload in messages)
Search (with filters)	Full-text search across messages and files, with modifiers (from:, in:, has:link).	Partial	Basic search/filter for messages (by date, recipient, campaign) would help admins/ faculty find past communications.	**Include** (simple search in Logs); advanced modifiers optional.
Pinned/ Starred Items	Pin important messages to a channel's Pins tab【36†L123-L133】. Users can "star" (save) messages or channels.	Absent	Without channels, pinning isn't relevant. Key messages can be shown in dashboards or notifications.	**Exclude**
Reminders (/ remind)	`/remind` command to set personal or group reminders (Slackbot).	Partial	SACP inherently schedules campaign sends. Personal "remind me" tasks not core to academic comms.	**Include scheduling** for campaigns; skip personal reminders.
Message Scheduling	Slack UI to schedule messages for later (added in 2021).	Present	Equivalent to scheduling broadcasts/ campaigns. Necessary for planned announcements.	**Include** (faculty can schedule sends).
Calls (Voice/ Video)	One-on-one or small group voice and video calls (screen sharing) in Slack.	Absent	Not in SACP scope.	**Exclude**

Slack Feature	Slack Description (official)	SACP	Rationale & Comparison	Recommendation
Huddles	Quick, lightweight audio/video chats in any channel/DM 【22†L17-L19】.	Absent	Also beyond scope.	**Exclude**
Screen Share / Clips	Share screen, record short video clips in Slack Huddles.	Absent	No (chat is text-based).	**Exclude**
Polls/Forms	No native poll; can create forms via Workflow Builder.	Absent/ Optional	Not in core proposal. Could be an optional "survey" feature if needed.	**Optional** (low priority)
Message Actions & Shortcuts	Message context menus (... menu) for actions like "Copy link", workflows.	Partial	SACP might have context actions (e.g. "Send reminder on this alert"), but Slack-like menu is unnecessary.	**Not needed initially**
Apps & Integrations	2000+ third-party apps (Jira, Google Drive, etc.) and built-in Slackbot.	Absent	SACP is closed system focusing on academic data; no external app ecosystem.	**Exclude**
Bots & Slackbot	Slackbot (built-in assistant), plus custom bots via API.	Absent	No chatbot; SACP automations are predefined rules, not interactive bots.	**Exclude**
Workflow Builder	No-code automation for processes (connect Slack to apps, conditional logic)【34†L8-L12】.	Present	Core SACP feature ("Automation Rules/ Workflows"). SACP provides GUI to set up event-triggered workflows (e.g. attendance triggers).	**Include** (academic workflow editor)
AI Features (Summaries)	AI-powered recaps, channel summaries, search answers 【34†L8-L12】.	Partial	SACP uses AI to classify/prioritize messages. Other Slack AI (summaries, translation) not needed.	**Use ML for inbox triage; skip summaries.**

Slack Feature	Slack Description (official)	SACP	Rationale & Comparison	Recommendation
User Profiles	Each user has profile details (name, title, etc.).	Partial	SACP has student/ faculty records (name, major, etc.) — akin to profiles.	**Include basic profile view.**
User Status/ Presence	Set status (emoji + text) and shows online/away indicator.	Absent	Not needed for SACP.	**Exclude**
User Groups (@here, @channel)	Special mention tags for all members of a channel/team.	Absent	No generic user groups; communication is by target list.	**Exclude**
Org Settings (domain, SSO)	Workspace-wide settings; SAML SSO login, domain claiming【14†L132-L139】.	Partial	SACP could allow admin setup (e.g. auth method). SSO is a possible integration but not core.	**Exclude for now** (simple auth)
Roles & Permissions	Owners, Admins, Members, Guests; custom roles (Enterprise) 【14†L163-L170】.	Partial	SACP has fixed Admin, Faculty, Student roles with clear rights.	**Include fixed roles** (Admin/Faculty/ Student)
Audit Logs & Compliance	Enterprise logs of all actions; message export for legal 【14†L148-L156】.	Partial	Maintain communication logs (message history). Full compliance tools likely not needed unless required.	**Include logging**; full compliance export optional.
Message Retention Policies	Custom retention schedules (delete old content)【14†L148-L156】.	Optional	Could allow admin to define how long to keep messages (institutional policy).	**Optional**
Data Encryption & Security	Encryption at rest/in transit; 2FA; HIPAA compliance (Enterprise) 【14†L132-L139】.	Present	SACP should secure data (TLS, hashed storage). 2FA good for admin.	**Include TLS encryption, 2FA for admins.**

Slack Feature	Slack Description (official)	SACP	Rationale & Comparison	Recommendation
Mobile App (iOS/Android)	Native mobile clients.	Partial	Likely start with responsive web; dedicated apps later if needed.	**Web-responsive first**
Desktop Client	Native apps for Windows/Mac/Linux.	Absent/ Partial	Provide web client. Desktop app not required.	**Web client only**
Multi-Workspace / Slack Connect	Enterprise Grid (multiple orgs) and shared channels with external companies 【39†L8-L12】.	Absent	SACP used by one institution; no external org collaboration needed.	**Exclude**
Guest Accounts	Single/multi-channel guests in Slack.	Absent	Not applicable.	**Exclude**
Workspace Directory	List of all users in workspace.	Partial	SACP can have a directory of students and faculty (for admin/ faculty use).	**Include** (admin/ faculty user list)
Notifications	In-app notifications for mentions, DMs; optional email/push.	Present	SACP should notify recipients of new messages or tasks.	**Include** (bell icon, email alerts)
Onboarding & Templates	Slack provides onboarding tips and some “workspace templates”.	Partial	SACP could include a welcome tutorial for admins and sample message templates for faculty (attendance warning, exam notice).	**Include** (initial setup help and sample templates)

Overall, SACP should **adopt the Slack features that directly support its academic-communication goals** (e.g. messaging, scheduled campaigns, workflows/rules, analytics) while **omitting general-purpose collaboration features** that fall outside its scope (calls, external channels, custom apps, fun UI add-ons). The UI/UX should emphasize simplicity and role-focus: on each dashboard (Admin/Faculty/Student), surface the actionable items (e.g. unread important messages for students, pending campaigns for faculty, system alerts for admins) rather than Slack’s broad sidebar of apps. The final comparison table and diagrams summarize this mapping between Slack’s comprehensive feature set and the streamlined feature set proposed for SACP.